Develop Self-Compassion

Hypnosis Script

Develop Self-Compassion

You are listening to me today because you recognise that, in the past, you have been very hard on yourself and you would like to develop more self-compassion.

There have been times when, after doing or saying something silly, you judged or questioned yourself, almost immediately or perhaps some time afterwards, deciding that you must be a bad person for thinking or reacting in the way that you did.

Deep down, you know that if a friend had said or done the same thing, you would have reacted more kindly and told them that it really didn't matter and then not given whatever it was a second thought.

You always seem to be much harder on yourself than you would be with someone else and this is a reaction that you have decided to put right.

But we live in a competitive world where it always seems that you need to be better and smarter than others around you.

It can be easy to fall into the trap of unconsciously believing that if you criticize and push yourself hard enough, it will be a good thing and help you improve or stay on track with important tasks.

However, researchers who study self-criticism and self-compassion, say it is a myth that beating yourself up or chastising yourself with harsh thoughts will keep you accountable and prevent you from being lazy or self-indulgent.

If you are frequently saying unkind things to yourself, about yourself, it is highly

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likely that your mental health will suffer, and instead, you will sabotage any efforts to do or perform better in life.

Developing a genuine self-compassion is a much kinder approach and it makes you feel better, enabling you to approach situations in a more optimistic frame of mind and increasing the likelihood of achieving a more desirable outcome.

How you talk to yourself can be a combination of genetic tendencies and environmental influences; some of us have brains that are hard-wired to be harshly self-critical or our families, friends, or larger society teach us that self-criticism will make us a better person, and so we enter a vicious cycle and learn to repeat the process and do it even more.

Fortunately, you can protect yourself against genetic and socially induced tendencies toward destructive self-criticism by using your wonderful, creative, subconscious mind.

The human mind is a highly sophisticated computer, far more technically advanced and incredible than any man-made device; in fact, it is estimated that there are approximately 86 billion neurons in the human brain.

The latest estimates for the number of stars in the Milky Way is somewhere between 200 and 400 billion so that may give you a comparison of how vast it potentially is.

The universe contains organized structures on all different scales, from small systems like the earth and our solar system to galaxies that contain trillions of stars, and finally extremely large structures that contain billions of galaxies.

The complex web of neurons inside our brains looks strangely similar to the cosmic network of galaxies.

Despite the overwhelming size difference, the human brain shows similar levels of complexity and self-organization.

Our brain cells (neurons) and the connections between them are constantly changing, which enables us to learn and remember, acquire new skills, and recover from brain injury.

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Like any computer, however, it is nothing without its operating system and the software to make it run.

Hypnosis can be thought of as the software program where the code can be re-written to help it run smoother and perform the tasks you require.

Now, somewhere along your earlier timeline, your old program prioritized being tough on yourself in situations where others would be more compassionate.

This program may have been installed at a time in your life when you were vulnerable or it could have happened as a result of negative conditioning, self-talk or any number of reasons.

It’s not important what happened in the past to create that program; what is important is now and your realisation that there are much better ways for you to react.

You can overwrite the old program, install a new one and write it to prioritize love and compassion towards yourself.

Changing lifelong patterns can take a little time and effort, but it will be well worth it when you learn how much better you can feel and when you can act like a supportive friend to yourself, instead of your own worst enemy.

Self-hypnosis is going to help you to change your programming to be kinder and more understanding toward yourself.

And you will use hypnosis any time you wish, especially in the unlikely event that you notice your thinking beginning to fall again into a self-critical pattern.

So go deeper into hypnosis and be aware of how comfortably relaxed and safe you are as you continue listening to the sound of my voice.

Short pause.

That’s good; you are doing so well.

And now that you are in this relaxed and comfortable state, I want you to think about the area of your life that usually caused you to feel upset.

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I'll talk about two of the most common ones but if these don't apply to you, please feel free to substitute them with ones that do.

The first is making a mistake.

Maybe you occasionally say something that is incorrect or perhaps you have failed in the past at something important to you at work or in a personal relationship.

And as soon as you realised your error, you started to criticise yourself for making that mistake.

Does that sound familiar?

If so, allow your unconscious to help you reprogram how you react to making a mistake.

As I say each statement, picture the statement floating in the air around you in a speech bubble or word cloud.

Then turn my words into a beautiful purple mist that surrounds you with healing purple light or a light of any other color that your unconscious mind associates with healing.

I am learning and growing, so if I didn't do something perfectly or well, I accept that I can do better next time.

Short pause.

As the wonderful human being that I am, I recognise that none of us is perfect, and making mistakes is the way that we learn.

Short pause.

If I feel upset about having made a mistake, I can observe my emotion and just let it be. Having emotions is perfectly acceptable and means that I am a normal human being.

Short pause.

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That's good. Now let yourself sink deeper into relaxation by focusing on your feet, your legs and then the middle of your body and your arms, and especially your jaw and face.

Let any tension you are holding drift away.

Short pause.

You are doing so well.

The second area for your unconscious mind to change is the feeling of regret that you often carry with you after the event; regrets about past decisions that are too late to change.

Let's practice self-compassion about these decisions.

Again, as I say each statement, picture the statement floating in the air around you as a word cloud or in a speech bubble and then turn them into a beautiful colorful mist that surrounds you and increases your feelings of safety and comfort.

I made a decision with the best information I had at the time.

Short pause.

Living a long life means there is more time to experience regret, but I am grateful to be on the planet and have this opportunity to reflect on my past decisions.

Short pause.

I can let myself feel some sadness, maybe even anger at the way some things have turned out, but as long as I am alive, I can make new decisions in areas where I still have control and opportunity.

Short pause.

Many therapists teach that when you increase compassion toward other people, your amount of compassion increases overall and spills over into helping you to feel compassion toward yourself as well.

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When someone does something that annoys you, try to imagine what new information would help for you to feel compassion toward them.

Short pause.

For example, suppose a woman cuts you off in traffic and you feel immediate anger and annoyance.

If you learned that her child had a life-threatening allergy and had gone into anaphylactic shock and she was speeding to the hospital, would you be able to feel compassion then?

Practice giving other people the benefit of the doubt to see if this helps you to feel better toward them and then eventually toward yourself.

A professor named Kristin Neff has dedicated her life to studying self-compassion and teaching people how to feel more of it.

Practising self-compassion increases life satisfaction, happiness, and hope.

An easy way to feel compassion towards yourself and others is to use a technique known as concentrated breathing.

To do this, you will begin to pay closer attention to your breathing.

As you breathe in, imagine you are breathing in compassion for yourself.

Short pause.

Breathe in; taking in warmth and kindness.

Reassure yourself that you are doing the best you can, moment by moment.

Short pause.

When you breathe out, send compassion to someone else who needs it.

Reassure yourself that they are also doing the best that they can, moment by moment.

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Short pause.

You are doing well. Breathe in warmth and kindness towards yourself.

Short pause.

And now breathe out, sending warmth and kindness to the other person.

Short pause.

Breathe in again, taking in more warmth and kindness.

Short pause.

Breathe out again, sending more warmth and kindness to the other person.

Short pause.

Continue this breathing technique, breathing in and out as long as you wish and with each breath in, taking in more warmth and kindness and with each breath out sending more warmth and kindness to the other person.

Practice this exercise regularly to remind yourself of your new program of self-compassion for life.

You might find this exercise a little difficult in the beginning; if so; remind yourself that empathy for yourself and others is like a muscle that needs to be exercised in order to get stronger over time.

Each time you see the color that you associate with healing, your unconscious mind will work to change your program toward self-compassion.

You are now becoming a more compassionate person, compassionate towards yourself and others and these changes are taking place on a deeper level of mind and grow stronger and stronger with each and every passing day.

You are kind to yourself and you are kind to others.

You love yourself and you love other people.

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People like you because you like them and you respect other people and you respect yourself.

You are a kind and compassionate human being and deep inside, something has softened and you already feel much calmer, happier and more content.

And these suggestions are firmly embedded in your subconscious mind and grow stronger and stronger with each and every passing moment in time.

Very soon, I am going to count the numbers from one to five and at the count of five, you will be fully alert and refreshed and ready to allow these suggestions to work for you.

So if you are ready, let us begin.

One, two, three, you are coming slowly back.

Four, your eyelids are beginning to flutter and five, you are already feeling much calmer, happier and more compassionate as your eyes fully open and you are wide, wide, wide awake.

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